

FROZEN CLAIM SHEET

Where Do Climate-Affected Households Go?

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MAIN CLAIM

Across two independent Bangladesh surveys, four pre-specified district GIS measures improve out-of-sample destination probabilities relative to the same fitted gravity model. The evidence supports a predictive claim about where observed movers go. It does not identify a causal effect of any GIS characteristic on migration.

PRIMARY ESTIMATES

BEMP shock-linked moves: 184 events, gain 0.108 [0.023, 0.189]. BIHS erosion moves: 123 events, gain 0.098 [0.028, 0.163]. BIHS national migrants: 1,857 events, gain 0.108 [0.082, 0.135]. Positive gain equals gravity log loss minus GIS log loss.

GENERALIZATION BOUNDARY

The national BIHS model transfers to origins omitted from training: full-choice gain 0.101 [0.074, 0.128], interdistrict gain 0.107 [0.073, 0.144]. BIHS erosion moves do not support the same full-choice transfer: -0.016 [-0.086, 0.045]. Their interdistrict gain remains positive at 0.058 [-0.034, 0.140]. BEMP shows the same directional split.

HUMAN ILLUSTRATION

An anonymized household head reported moving from Faridpur to Manikganj in 2010 after erosion-related land loss. Gravity assigned Manikganj 7.0% probability and rank 6 of 64. GIS assigned 13.7% and rank 2. The case illustrates prediction; it does not reveal private reasoning.

PERMITTED LANGUAGE

Use predicts, improves held-out probability, is associated with, and transfers across held-out origins. Do not use causes, proves preference, climate refugee, nationally representative climate displacement, or village-level claims. Public origins and destinations are districts.